

Sarah Johnson

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• github.com/sarahjohnson

SUMMARY

Dynamic and collaborative software engineering leader with 6+ years of hands-on experience at the intersection of backend development, AI-driven products, and scalable cloud infrastructure. Proven ability to architect and deliver robust payment integrations, design developer-focused tooling, and drive company-wide technical direction in fast-moving environments. Excels at collaborating across product, engineering, and sales to build innovative platforms that power next-generation AI and payments solutions.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager / Founding Engineer, Backend & AI Microsoft • microsoft.com

03/2021 – Present
Redmond, WA / Remote

- Spearheaded architecture and delivery of distributed payment infrastructure and AI-powered features in Azure DevOps, serving 2M+ active users.
- Built robust integrations between internal AI models, external API providers, and payment processing systems, reducing payment errors by 37% and optimizing transaction speed.
- Designed and scaled backend services for developer tools, employing microservices, containerization, and event-driven systems on Azure (Kubernetes, Service Bus).
- Acted as forward-deployed engineer in high-impact enterprise sales calls, translating technical requirements and influencing feature adoption.
- Championed adoption of OKRs and agile processes to align cross-functional engineering teams, boosting delivery velocity by 30%.
- Collaborated with founders, sales, and product to set long-term technical roadmap, ensuring platform scalability and security.

Product Manager, Backend Systems & Payments Amazon • amazon.com

06/2018 – 02/2021
Seattle, WA

- Owned architecture and delivery for high-throughput seller payment systems, handling billions in annual transaction volume with 99.99% uptime.
- Led cross-functional efforts to integrate AI-powered fraud detection and automate payment reconciliation, reducing losses by 22%.
- Collaborated with engineering to build developer tools and APIs for 100K+ merchants, increasing API onboarding rate by 45%.
- Conducted direct user and customer discovery, translating insights into infrastructure improvements for enhanced reliability and scalability.
- Presented technical solutions and product strategy to VP-level stakeholders, directly shaping organizational priorities.

KEY PROJECTS

Internal AI Payment Integrator • Platform Tool • github.com/sarahjohnson

- Built a secure, scalable tool integrating AI-based transaction approval workflows with Stripe and Plaid APIs, enabling near real-time payments and fraud checks.
- Achieved a 40% reduction in payment processing incidents and automated compliance reporting for finance stakeholders.

Open-Source Product Management Framework • Open Source • github.com/sarahjohnson/pm-framework

- Created a modular framework for developer-tooling and workflow automation, earning 1,000+ GitHub stars and 50+ active contributors.
- Empowered product and engineering teams across organizations to rapidly prototype, deploy, and measure feature experiments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, JavaScript (Node.js), SQL, Go

Frameworks/Tools: Azure, AWS, REST APIs, Docker, Kubernetes, Stripe, Plaid, AI/ML APIs, Mixpanel, Amplitude

AI/ML: AI API integration (OpenAI, custom LLMs), ML pipeline design, A/B experimentation, Data Analytics

Infrastructure: Distributed systems, microservices architecture, scalable cloud computing, developer tooling

Soft Skills: Technical leadership, cross-functional collaboration, client-facing presentations, agile delivery

EDUCATION

MBA in Technology Management • Stanford Graduate School of Business • Stanford, CA • 2018 • GPA: 3.9/4.0
Dean's List, Product Management Fellowship

B.S. in Computer Science • University of Texas at Austin • Austin, TX • 2016 • GPA: 3.7/4.0